

Waste Management Policy

VERSION 1.0	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER Principal / Key Management Personnel	APPROVED BY Governing body
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PURPOSE AT A GLANCE

This policy explains how [] protects participants, workers and others from harm arising from waste, infectious or hazardous substances generated during support — through safe segregation, storage, handling and disposal that complies with legislation, worker training, and an emergency plan for spills.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy supports [] to apply the Management of Waste NDIS Practice Standard. It applies to all services and supports delivered by [] and to all employees, contractors and volunteers (**Workers**), who must take full responsibility for understanding and following it. It should be read alongside the related documents in the final section and the corresponding procedures in the Policy Register.

2. Policy aims

[] is committed to ensuring that:

- each participant, worker and any other person in the home is protected from harm as a result of exposure to waste, infectious or hazardous substances generated during the delivery of supports;
- policies, procedures and practices are in place for safe and appropriate storage and disposal of waste that comply with current legislation and local health district requirements, and all incidents involving infectious material, body substances or hazardous substances are reported, recorded, investigated and reviewed; and
- an emergency plan is in place for clinical waste or hazardous substance issues, and workers involved in waste management are trained in safe handling, including the protective equipment required.

3. Why it matters

Clinical and related wastes present risks in handling, storing, transporting and disposing — to the people who handle them and to the public if not managed correctly, and to the environment. [] minimises harm by complying with waste management regulations and by ensuring the safety of workers (through information, processes and equipment), the safety of participants and their families (by building their capacity to manage clinical waste generated in their homes), and the safety of the public, while minimising environmental pollution and continually improving its waste-handling processes.

4. Segregation, storage and disposal

Specific waste streams are managed in line with State legislation and licensing and the Waste Management Plan, which sets out each waste type, examples, on-site management, container and bin colours (to Australian Standard AS 4123.7), and the off-site disposal method. Clinical waste is placed in yellow clinical-

waste containers or bags marked with the biohazard symbol and disposed of at a licensed premises; cytotoxic waste in rigid purple containers for incineration at a licensed facility; pharmaceutical waste returned to a pharmacy; sharps in an approved puncture-resistant container, never picked up by hand; and general waste as domestic waste unless contaminated.

5. Worker responsibilities and training

Workers understand the hazards present, use the correct containers and PPE, do not overfill containers, and report any incident involving infectious material, body substances or hazardous substances so it can be recorded, investigated and reviewed. Workers involved in waste management receive training in safe handling. Records of waste generated and removed are kept in the Waste Removal Records Register, and a Waste Management Report is completed periodically. The Emergency Waste Management Plan applies to spills of hazardous substances.

6. Definitions

[]
[], ABN [].

Client

A client of [], including an NDIS participant.

Key Management Personnel (KMP)

[], and other key management personnel involved in [] from time to time.

Principal

[].

Legislation Register

The register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by [].

Policy Register

The register of policies of [].

Worker

A permanent, fixed-term or casual member of staff, a contractor or a volunteer engaged by [], including the Principal.

Clinical waste

Waste that has the potential to cause a sharps injury, infection or disease.

Cytotoxic waste

Material that is, or may be, contaminated with a cytotoxic drug during preparation, transport or administration.

Sharps

Any object capable of inflicting a penetrating injury, which may or may not be contaminated with blood or body substances — including hypodermic needles, IV sets, pipettes and broken glassware.

Related waste

Waste that constitutes, or is contaminated with, chemicals, cytotoxic drugs, human body parts, pharmaceutical products or radioactive substances.

7. Related documents and approval

Related documents: Waste Management Plan · Emergency Waste Management Plan · Waste Management Report · Waste Removal Records Register · Infection Control Policy · Work Health and Safety Policy · Incident Management and Reporting Policy · Legislation Register · Policy Register.

Legislation and rules: as set out in the Legislation Register. If any part of this policy is inconsistent with applicable law, it is taken to be amended only to the extent needed to comply.

Approved by	
Approval date	
Next scheduled review	
Version	1.0